

UNIT 10 / Work, messages and your final mission

Yesterday and last weekend

Your goal: Understand a first set of past-tense sentences.

01 Learn the idea

For sein and haben, common past forms include ich war, du warst, er war and ich hatte, du hattest, er hatte. Ich war zu Hause means I was at home. Use gestern or am Wochenende to make the time clear. These simple forms are useful in everyday conversation.

The conversational perfect often uses haben plus a participle: Ich habe Deutsch gelernt. Some movement verbs use sein: Ich bin nach Köln gefahren. The auxiliary is conjugated and the participle goes at the end. This lesson introduces a small set of complete patterns; practise them before extending to many irregular verbs.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich war zu Hause.	I was at home.
Ich hatte Zeit.	I had time.
Ich habe Deutsch gelernt.	I studied German.
Ich habe gekocht.	I cooked.
Ich bin nach Köln gefahren.	I travelled to Cologne.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Was hast du gestern gemacht?

What did you do yesterday?

Ben

Ich war zu Hause. Ich habe Deutsch gelernt und gekocht.

I was at home. I studied German and cooked.

Mia

Ich bin nach Köln gefahren.

I travelled to Cologne.

Your real-life mission

Write a three-sentence diary for a fictional yesterday. Use *war* once, *habe plus a participle* once and *bin gefahren* once.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich war zu Hause.” mean?

- A. I was at home.
- B. I had time.
- C. I studied German.

2. What does “Ich hatte Zeit.” mean?

- A. I studied German.
- B. I had time.
- C. I cooked.

3. What does “Ich habe Deutsch gelernt.” mean?

- A. I cooked.
- B. I travelled to Cologne.
- C. I studied German.

4. Complete: Ich ____ nach Köln gefahren.

- A. habe
- B. bin
- C. hatte

5. Who travelled to Cologne?

- A. Ben
- B. Both speakers
- C. Mia

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. A - I was at home.

“Ich war zu Hause.” means “I was at home.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. B - I had time.

“Ich hatte Zeit.” means “I had time.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. C - I studied German.

“Ich habe Deutsch gelernt.” means “I studied German.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - bin

Fahren used for travelling to a destination forms this perfect tense with sein: bin gefahren.

5. C - Mia

Mia says Ich bin nach Köln gefahren.

One possible mission response

Gestern war ich zu Hause. Ich habe Deutsch gelernt. Am Abend bin ich nach Köln gefahren.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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